

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #2405

Name
RUIQI LI
Email
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Gender
Male
City, state, and country of residence
Boulder, Colorado, USA
Nationality
China
When did or will you finish your PhD?
Fall 2023
University Education
PhD Ecology and Evolutionary Biology University of Colorado Boulder, USA Expected Fall 2023 B.S. Marine Biology Xiamen University, PR China June 2018 Visiting student Semester by the Sea Darling Marine Center, USA Fall 2016 Visiting student Marine Science National Sun Yat-sen University, Taiwan Spring 2016
What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?
Growing up in a developing country myself, I understand the multifarious barriers such as information gap and salary prospect that prevent young talents from contributing to the development of science, especially in less practical subjects such as evolutionary biology. Colonialism in science is still not uncommon in the field of biology, which is largely due to inequality in educational resources. I am passionate about educational equity. By being a Science Corps fellow, I look forward to helping Philippine students break the barriers, especially in filling the information gap in college application and career choices (with my own experience as an international student as well as drawing from resources around me.) I would like to encourage more Philippine students pursue a career in evolutionary biology. Besides, the research project in CVIF aligns with my research interests. Philippine is a hotspot for my study system – heart cockles. I would like to develop independent projects or citizen science projects that will help me understand more about the evolution, behaviors, and ecology of those amazing animals, and potentially discover cryptic species. Those projects will also help students understand scientific methods and get hand-on experience on basic molecular lab bench skills.

Moreover, I would like to further develop my intercultural communication skills, apply my pedagogical philosophy to real-world teaching, and engage more in science communications. I am also passionate about making science education open and inclusive.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

My multicultural experience during my academic journey helps me work with people from diverse backgrounds. Growing up in China, I have studied in China, Taiwan, Malaysia, and the USA. I conducted month-long field work in Guam, Panama, and France during my PhD. I learned how to be open-minded, how to respect culture differences, and I appreciate the productivity that brought by diversity. Teaching in a different country is challenging, but I am excited about being in a new country, learning from their culture and expertise. I believe my open-mindedness will help me become a great teacher in the international community in CVIF.

Besides, I have ample experiences working with K-12 students: From organizing marine science events and volunteering as a guide in the Museum of Marine Science and Technology at Xiamen University, to giving lectures and teaching in high school as a science ambassador during my PhD in CU Boulder. I also mentored undergraduate students during my PhD for independent projects: for example, one of my mentees learned molecular lab bench skills (e.g., DNA extraction, gel electrophoresis, PCR) and basic bioinformatics (e.g., BLAST). She is now pursuing her graduate degree at the University of Hawaii thanks to her research experience. In CVIF, I will not only be able to teach high school level biology class, but will also be capable of helping students develop independent research, as well as mentoring them for college application in the Evo-Devo track.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia
In science education

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

I enjoy tackling scientific questions and expanding our boundaries of knowledge. I would like to continue my journey in academia. I also believe that education and outreach are the ways to take the impacts of our research to the next level. Engaging next generations and the public will make a difference.

After graduation, I will apply for a post-doc position. A post-doc will help me expand my research interests, tune my scientific skills, and prepare me to be an independent researcher. I will prioritize the postdoctoral fellowships with teaching components. I would like to develop my curriculum in evolutionary biology, biodiversity, and taxonomy, which will include state-of-art technologies, conservation applications, and hand-on experiments.

In the long term, I would like to become a college professor. I would like to continue exploring marine biodiversity with talented students from diverse backgrounds. I would like to bring my research to a broader audience and engaging in international conservation efforts. I would like to be the bridge in the international collaboration projects on biodiversity, conservation, and engage in policy making such as establishing marine protective areas.

CV/Resume [Ruiqi_CV_Oct2022.pdf](#)**How did you find out about Science Corps?**

A friend or colleague

Any other comments/questions?

Empty

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